



OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER

Welcome to the Arike Palliative Home Care Bulletin!

Within these pages, we share the stories and highlights of our work, emphasizing the difference it makes in the community. Your continued support helps us move forward and reach more people in need. Thank you for being with us on this journey.

Echoes of Care: Reflections from Volunteers

Compassion is what makes us truly human. Care transforms both the giver and the receiver. This month, we share stories from our volunteers that reveal the deep impact of compassionate care.

"There are moments that leave an indelible mark on the heart when home care visits require us to step into the lives of various families. One recent visit has stayed vividly in my memory. We visited a modest household of three—a father, his wife, and their adult son. The head of the household, who once ran a typewriting institute in Ernakulam, was now confined to his bed due to ailments of old age. His care was in the hands of his son, who faced mental health challenges, and his wife, who we later discovered had been a teacher.

The father's condition had grown dire, worsened by the fact that neither caregiver had the capacity to fully comprehend or address his needs. When we arrived, the scene was heart-wrenching: his body was riddled with wounds, some already infested with maggots. He lay on a makeshift bed made of benches, covered by a thin sheet, crying out in pain. The moment we touched him to begin cleaning, his cries grew louder, expressing a torment that resonated in our ears and hearts.

Under the diligent care of sisters from Arike, it took nearly two hours to cleanse the wounds and settle him on a clean, air bed. When my friend and I helped support him, he wept in helplessness—a sound that echoes in my ears even now.

I left that house with a silent prayer: no living being, human or otherwise, should ever endure such suffering. The thought haunted me—if only he had received proper palliative care earlier, this profound deterioration could have been prevented."

Each volunteer at Arike carries with them unique stories. These experiences capture the true spirit of palliative care, showing how it touches not just the lives of patients and their families but also the hearts of those who serve.

"My initial understanding of palliative care was, to be honest, quite limited. It was only after immersing myself in Arike's work that I truly comprehend its significance. I came to realize that palliative care is not just a service but a necessity—one that every person might require at some point. Through the home visits and the training programs, I learnt invaluable lessons that no textbook could ever teach.

Accompanying the nurses into patients' homes and having genuine, heartfelt conversations with them opened my eyes to a world I had never experienced before. It was challenging at first, adjusting to the emotional depth and resilience needed in this field, but as time passed, I found myself growing into the role and connecting deeply with both the work and the people. Even though my time with Arike was short, I can confidently say that the insights and knowledge I gained will have a lasting impact on my life."

Volunteering at Arike offers an opportunity not only to make a meaningful difference in the lives of patients and their families but also to gain invaluable experiences that will stay with you for a lifetime. Whether you're looking to share your skills, offer support, or learn from hands-on experiences, Arike warmly invites you to join our journey.



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24/7
Emergency
Home Care

New Vehicles for Arike



Arike has received a specially customized Maruti Suzuki Ertiga, provided by Muthoot Finance through IMA Cochin, to support individuals with disabilities. This vehicle allows wheelchair users to enter and travel without needing to get out of their chairs, enhancing comfort and accessibility. This valuable contribution was handed over at a special ceremony held at Muthoot's corporate office in Kochi, attended by Shri. Hibi Eden MP, Muthoot Finance Deputy Managing Director Shri. George Muthoot and IMA representatives. The vehicle, maintained and serviced by Arike, will greatly improve our ability to facilitate transportation for those with disabilities.



Arike Palliative Care extends heartfelt thanks to Federal Bank and IMA Cochin for their donation of an MG Comet car. This will strengthen our home care efforts, supporting more visits and better patient care.

ACTIVITIES

World Hospice and Palliative Care Day at IMA

On October 12th, Arike Palliative Home Care observed the World Hospice and Palliative Care Day at the IMA Hall in Cochin. The day aims to raise awareness and support for hospice and palliative care worldwide, promoting compassion, dignity, and quality of life for individuals with serious illnesses. 60 participants from 17 Hospices centers & hospitals participated in the event.



Training of Trainers Workshop

Arike conducted a two-day Training of Trainers (ToT) workshop on October 3rd and 4th, 2024, at House of Hope, Elamkunnappuzha. This interactive and immersive programme was designed to equip experienced professionals with the skills and confidence needed to train and inspire others in palliative care volunteering. The workshop brought together 35 participants who learnt effective approaches to promote palliative care, develop volunteer programmes, and inspire more people to join the cause. Through practical sessions and shared experiences, the workshop aimed to build a network of trainers who can engage communities and expand the reach of compassionate care.



Volunteer Training at Rajagiri College



On October 5, Rajagiri College of Management & Applied Sciences hosted a volunteer training session conducted by Arike. The training helped students understand the physical, psychological, social, and spiritual aspects of care, fostering empathy and a deeper comprehension of patient needs.

In the coming weeks, students will receive hands-on home care mentorship support from Arike, allowing them to apply their knowledge and gain practical experience in palliative care volunteering.

Spreading Awareness

On October 6, Arike set up a stall to educate patients and families on the importance and benefits of palliative care during the annual program organized by the Ernakulam District Residents' Association Apex Council (EDRAAC) at Town Hall, Ernakulam.



Arike Review Meeting



On October 19th, a review meeting with volunteers and team members was held at Arike Conference Hall, Palarivattom. This gathering provided a platform for participants to collaborate, share insights, and assess the delivery of care while addressing care related concerns. The session facilitated open discussions to sort out challenges and included expert mentoring to enhance practices. Arike remains dedicated to deepening its relationship with the community through continuous training, volunteer involvement, and open communication, building a network that supports patients, families, and caregivers.

Volunteers Course in Palliative Care- IXth Batch

On October 26, Arike Palliative Care welcomed the ninth batch of participants to its monthly Volunteers Course in Palliative Care (VCPC). This Volunteers Course in Palliative Care- programme equips community members with essential skills and knowledge to support individuals needing palliative care. Participants receive both theoretical instruction and hands-on experience, including home visits, to develop a deep understanding and practical skills for patient care.

Join us for next month's VCPC.
Call 703 4336 999 to register.



Law Talk Live

Arike Palliative Care hosted Law Talk Live, a programme aimed at providing legal awareness. This session was part of a community programme conducted by social work trainees from Rajagiri College of Social Sciences. Adv. Bibin James was the resource person for the session held on October 20, 2024. The programme was conducted in collaboration with the Rotaract Club of Rajagiri College and SIP, enhancing community engagement and education on essential legal areas.

'Unarv' at CUSAT and St. Teresa's College

Arike conducted Unarv palliative care training programmes, comprehensive 10-hour sessions designed to blend compassion with hands-on experience. These programmes were organized in collaboration with the Ernakulam Students Initiative in Palliative Care to equip participants with essential skills for caring for individuals with serious illnesses.

The session at CUSAT was held on October 22 and was organized by the Cochin University Students Union. It provided students with practical training and insights into palliative care practices. The Unarv programme at St. Teresa's College, Ernakulam, was held on October 28.



Wheelchair Family Gathering

On October 29, 2024, a wheelchair family gathering was held at Bethany Shalom Bhavan, organized by the Sisters of the Imitation of Christ. Arike collaborated and participated in this special event, which brought together individuals affected by paraplegia and their families, fostering a sense of community and support.



Workshop on Advancing Pediatric Palliative Care

On October 13, 2024, a workshop on the future of Pediatric Palliative Care was held at IMA House, Cochin, organized by the National Health Mission, Indian Medical Association, Cochin, and the Community Resource Center in Health Care. This event brought together pediatricians, healthcare professionals, and key stakeholders to explore innovative strategies and develop action plans to enhance palliative care services for children and their families.



The Arike team actively participated in this workshop, reinforcing its commitment to Pediatric Palliative Care. Since its inception, Arike has been dedicated to bringing comfort, care, and hope to children and families navigating complex medical journeys. We plan to delve deeper into the insights gained and integrate them into our services.

Support Our Mission

Your support is vital to expanding our reach and ensuring that we continue to provide dignified care to those in need. We warmly encourage you to contribute to Arike, enabling us to make a meaningful and lasting difference in the lives of individuals requiring palliative care.

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